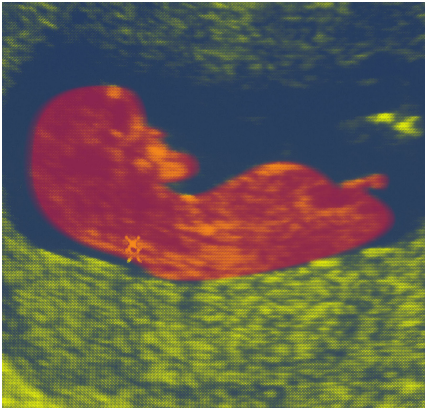




YOU ARE **13 WEEKS AND 6 DAYS**

183 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

In this color ultrasound image the baby is red and the placenta green. It is just possible to see the two crosses that measure the depth of fluid in the nuchal fold at the back of the neck (see [Nuchal translucency screening](#)). Now is the last opportunity to measure this reliably.

“Your baby is growing and getting stronger every day, and it’s all thanks to her life support system—the placenta.”

Your baby’s rapid growth continues and her weight will increase during the next three weeks from 1.5 oz (43 g) to 5 oz (140 g). Muscle and bone growth advances, but, although all joints are present, it will be three weeks before the skeleton begins to harden.

Your baby is now totally dependent on the placenta for her nourishment. Environmental factors have almost no influence on your baby’s size at this stage; all babies up until around 20 weeks’ gestation are the same size.

The placenta is larger than your baby and supplies all the nutrients she needs. To aid her growth, the placenta extracts amino acids from your circulation, giving her high levels. Amino acids are the building blocks of protein, from which muscles and organs develop.